

Women's Specialists of Clear Lake

Dr. Geoffrey H. Klein, MD · FACOG · DABOM · 400 W Medical Center Blvd, Suite 300, Webster, TX 77598 · (281) 557-0300

Safe Medications During Pregnancy

A quick reference guide of over-the-counter medications safe to use during pregnancy -- always check with our office if unsure

COLD, ALLERGIES & COUGH

- ✓ **Ocean Nasal Spray** -- saline, use as needed
- ✓ **Afrin Nasal Spray** -- no more than **3 days**
- ✓ **Tylenol Cold/Sinus** products, **Benadryl**, **Claritin**, **Claritin-D**, **Zyrtec**
- ✓ **Vicks Vapor Rub**, **Dimetapp Cold & Congestion**, **Mucinex**
- ✓ **Plain Robitussin Syrup** for cough

PAIN, FEVER & HEADACHE

- ✓ **Tylenol** or **Tylenol ES** (acetaminophen) -- first choice
- ✓ Call MD for **fever of 100.4°F or greater**
- ✓ **Chloraseptic**, salt water gargle, **Cepastat** lozenges for sore throat
- ✓ **Unisom** for occasional insomnia
- ✓ Dentist visits are safe -- use abdominal shield for X-rays

HEARTBURN & STOMACH

- ✓ **Indigestion:** Tums, Rolaids, Mylanta, Maalox, Pepcid, Zantac, Prilosec, Nexium
- ✓ **Constipation:** Milk of Magnesia, Dulcolax, Fibercon, Metamucil
- ✓ **Stool softeners:** Colace, Surfak, Metamucil
- ✓ **Diarrhea:** Kaopectate, Imodium AD, BRATT diet (bananas, rice, applesauce, tea, toast)
- ✓ **Hemorrhoids:** Preparation H, Tucks Pads, Anusol, RectiCare Advanced

NAUSEA & VOMITING

- ✓ **Vitamin B6** (25 mg, up to 3 times daily)
- ✓ **Ginger tablets** or **ginger tea**
- ✓ **Sea-Bands** (acupressure wristbands)
- ✓ **Emetrol** syrup
- ✓ **Dramamine** as needed
- ✓ Eat small, frequent meals; keep crackers bedside

YEAST, LEG CRAMPS & OTHER

- ✓ **Yeast infection:** Monistat over the counter
- ✓ **Leg cramps:** Viactiv with meals, increase **fluids** and calcium/magnesium foods (milk, yogurt, bananas, OJ, broccoli)
- ✓ Wear **support hose** throughout the day
- ✓ **Dental care is safe** -- call us if your dentist needs OB authorization

AVOID THESE DURING PREGNANCY

- **Motrin**, **Advil**, **Nuprin** (ibuprofen) and other NSAIDs
- **Aspirin** (unless prescribed)
- **Nyquil** (contains alcohol)
- **Pepto-Bismol**
- **Caffeine** (limit to <200 mg/day)
- **Alcohol** and **nicotine** -- completely avoid

⚠️ CALL THE OFFICE IMMEDIATELY IF YOU EXPERIENCE

- ⚠️ Fever of **100.4°F or higher**
- ⚠️ Diarrhea lasting **more than 24 hours**
- ⚠️ Unable to keep anything down for **more than 24 hours**
- ⚠️ Feeling **weak, dizzy, or dehydrated**
- ⚠️ Vaginal bleeding or leaking fluid
- ⚠️ Severe abdominal pain or regular contractions
- ⚠️ Decreased baby movements
- ⚠️ Severe headache or vision changes

When In Doubt, Call Us First

This is a general guide -- every pregnancy is unique. If you are unsure whether a medication is safe, call our office **before** taking it. For after-hours emergencies or labor, call **(281) 557-0300**. We're here to help you have the healthiest pregnancy possible!